

← Case report for event ID: 1015

ID	Alert rule	Description	Incident type	Severity level	Date and time detected
1015	Suspicious Parent Child Relationship	A suspicious process with an uncommon parent-child relationship was detected in your environment.	Process	Low	Dec 27th 2025 at 23:49

Alert details

Incident report

Edit report

Incident classification

☒ True positive

☐ False positive

Case report

Please write a detailed report on the steps taken to analyse and contain this incident, including all relevant information and the rationale for its closure.

- Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:47:23.164

- User Involved: According to Company Information > Directory:
Name: Yami Zubair
Email: yami.zubair@tryhatme.com
Role: IT

- Device: win-3449 (Windows host)

- Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:47:23.164, a process creation event was logged where TrustedInstaller.exe (PID 3535) was launched with parent process services.exe (PID 3965). The process executed from "C:\Windows\servicing\TrustedInstaller.exe" with working directory "C:\Windows\system32\". The activity was flagged due to an uncommon parent-child process relationship.

Malware identified: None identified.

Additional investigation:

- Additional info:
- Parent Process: "services.exe" is the Windows Service Control Manager responsible for starting and managing system services.
- Child Process: "TrustedInstaller.exe" is the Windows Modules Installer used to install, modify, and remove Windows updates and protected system components.

Does this alert require escalation?

☒ Yes

☐ No

Save and close alert.

- Alert 1015: Process
- Identified as True Positive
 - Requires escalation to L2
 - Full Report Documented on the last page

splunk>enterpriseApps

MessagesSettingsActivityHelpFind

SearchAnalyticsDatasetsReportsAlertsDashboards

Search & Reporting

New Search

Save AsCreate Table ViewClose

1 host.name="win-3449" process.name="TrustedInstaller.exe"

6 day window

1 of 2 events matchedNo Event Sampling

Events (1)PatternsStatisticsVisualization

Format TimelineZoom OutZoom to SelectionDeselect

1 hour per column

ListFormat50 Per Page

< Hide FieldsAll Fields

SELECTED FIELDS

a host 1

a source 1

a sourcetype 1

INTERESTING FIELDS

a datasource 1

a event.action 1

event.code 1

a host.name 1

a index 1

linecount 1

a process.command_line 1

a process.name 1

a process.parent.name 1

process.parent.pid 1

process.pid 1

a process.working_directory 1

a punct 1

a splunk_server 1

a timestamp 1

+ Extract New Fields

Time

12/27/25 3:48:36.248 PM

{ [-]

datasource: system

event.action: Process Create (rule: ProcessCreate)

event.code: 1

host.name: win-3449

process.command_line: C:\Windows\servicing\TrustedInstaller.exe

process.name: TrustedInstaller.exe

process.parent.name: services.exe

process.parent.pid: 3965

process.pid: 3535

process.working_directory: C:\Windows\system32\

timestamp: 12/27/2025 15:48:36.248

} Show as raw text

host = 10.10.178.106:8989 | source = eventcollector | sourcetype = _json

- SIEM Investigation
- The incident only happened once in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20)

Submitted report:

- Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:47:23.164

- User Involved: According to Company Information > Directory:

Name: Yani Zubair

Email: yani.zubair@tryhatme.com

Role: IT

Logged-in Host: win-3449

- Device: win-3449 (Windows host)

- Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:47:23.164, a process creation event was logged where TrustedInstaller.exe (PID 3535) was launched with parent process services.exe (PID 3965). The process executed from

`C:\Windows\servicing\TrustedInstaller.exe` with working directory `C:\Windows\system32\`. The activity was flagged due to an uncommon parent-child process relationship.

Malware Identified: None identified.

Additional Investigation:

Additional info:

Parent Process: `services.exe` is the Windows Service Control Manager responsible for starting and managing system services.

Child Process: `TrustedInstaller.exe` is the Windows Modules Installer used to install, modify, and remove Windows updates and protected system components.

Why This Is Uncommon: `TrustedInstaller.exe` typically runs during Windows Update or servicing operations and is not frequently observed outside update activity. This relationship is less commonly seen and should be validated to confirm legitimate system maintenance activity.

- Recommendations: Escalate to Level 2 (L2) for further investigation and handling.

- This is a True Positive

- This needs escalation to L2 for further investigation